Instagram API Verification

- Instagram API Verification Guide
  - 📋 Overview
  - ⚠️ IMPORTANT: Instagram = Meta Platform
  - 🎯 What You Need
    - Required:
  - 📱 Step 1: Instagram Business Account Setup
    - Convert Instagram Account to Business
  - 🔧 Step 2: Configure Meta App for Instagram
    - Process
  - 📊 Step 3: Understand Instagram APIs
    - Instagram Graph API (Recommended) ✅
  - 🔑 Step 4: Request Permissions
    - Important Instagram Permissions
  - 🎬 Step 5: App Review Submission
    - Process
  - 📏 Step 6: Understand Rate Limits
    - Instagram Graph API Rate Limits
  - 🚨 Common Mistakes
    - ❌ Mistake 1: Personal Account Used
    - ❌ Mistake 2: Not Linked to Facebook Page
    - ❌ Mistake 3: Skipped Business Verification
  - ⏱️ Complete Timeline
  - 📊 Content Posting Specifications
    - Photo Posts
    - Video Posts
    - Stories
    - Reels
  - ✅ Complete Checklist
    - Prerequisites:
    - App Setup:
    - Permissions:

Instagram API Verification Guide

Date: February 8, 2026 **Platform:** Instagram Graph API (via Meta) **Portal:** https://developers.facebook.com/

📋 Overview

Instagram API is part of Meta's developer platform. You do **NOT need a separate Instagram developer account** - everything is managed via Facebook's developer portal.

⚠️ IMPORTANT: Instagram = Meta Platform

What this means: - Instagram API is managed via developers.facebook.com - You need Meta Business Verification (see Facebook guide) - Instagram permissions are requested via Meta App Review - Same process as Facebook, but with Instagram-specific permissions

Prerequisites: - ✅ Meta developer account - ✅ Facebook Business Verification (MANDATORY) - ✅ Instagram Business Account (MANDATORY) - ✅ Instagram account linked to Facebook Page

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🎯 What You Need

Required:

1. **Meta Developer Account**
   - Account on developers.facebook.com
   - See: Facebook Verification Guide for complete setup
2. **Business Verification (Meta)**
   - Business documentation
   - Business email address
   - See: Facebook Verification Guide § Business Verification
3. **Instagram Business Account**
   - ⚠️ NOT personal account - must be Business/Creator
   - Free to convert in Instagram app
4. **Facebook Page**
   - Instagram Business account must be linked to Facebook Page
   - Managed via Facebook Business Manager

📱 Step 1: Instagram Business Account Setup

Convert Instagram Account to Business

1. **Open Instagram App**
   - Log in with your Instagram account
2. **Go to Settings**
   - Profile → Menu (☰) → Settings
3. **Switch to Professional Account**
   - Account → “Switch to Professional Account”
   - Choose “Business” (not Creator)
4. **Link to Facebook Page**
   - Settings → Account → Linked accounts → Facebook
   - Log in with Facebook
   - Select or create Facebook Page
   - ⚠️ You must be Admin of the Facebook Page
5. **Verify Linking**
   - Go to Facebook Page settings
   - Check that Instagram account is linked
   - Both sides must be connected

🔧 Step 2: Configure Meta App for Instagram

Process

1. **Go to Meta Developer Portal**
   - URL: https://developers.facebook.com/
   - Log in with your account
2. **Select or Create App**
   - "My Apps" → Select existing app
   - Or create new app: "Create App" → "Business" type
3. **Add Instagram Product**
   - Dashboard → "+ Add Products"
   - Select "Instagram"
   - Click "Set Up"
4. **OAuth Redirect URIs**
   - Settings → Basic → "Add Platform"
   - Choose "Website"
   - Add redirect URIs:
     - Development: `https://localhost:5173/auth/instagram/callback`
     - Production: `https://your-app.com/auth/instagram/callback`
5. **Add Test Users**
   - Instagram → "Instagram Testers"
   - Add Instagram accounts for testing
   - Testers must accept via Instagram app

📊 Step 3: Understand Instagram APIs

Instagram Graph API (Recommended) ✅

For: Business accounts only

What you can do: - Publish content (posts, stories, reels) - Media management - Manage comments - Insights & analytics - Fetch mentions - Hashtag research

Scopes: - `instagram_basic` - Profile + media access - `instagram_content_publish` - Post content - `instagram_manage_comments` - Manage comments - `instagram_manage_insights` - Fetch analytics

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🔑 Step 4: Request Permissions

Instagram permissions are requested via Meta's App Review (same process as Facebook).

Important Instagram Permissions

`instagram_basic`

Grants: - Basic profile info (username, account ID) - Media feed (photos, videos) - Media metadata

`instagram_content_publish`

Grants: - Publish photos - Publish videos - Post stories - Publish reels

`instagram_manage_comments`

Grants: - Read comments - Reply to comments - Hide/delete comments

`instagram_manage_insights`

Grants: - Post analytics (likes, comments, reach) - Account analytics (followers, impressions) - Story insights - Reel performance

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🎬 Step 5: App Review Submission

Process

1. **Go to App Review**
   - Dashboard → "App Review" → "Permissions and Features"
2. **Request Instagram Permissions**
   - Click "+ Request Advanced Access"
   - Select Instagram permissions
3. **For Each Permission: Video Walkthrough**

   Must include:

   - Instagram login flow
   - Permission usage
   - Data management
   - Security

   Technical requirements:

   - Max 10 minutes per permission
   - Screen recording
   - Use test accounts
   - No music/voice-over needed
4. **Describe Use Case**
5. **Provide Test Credentials**
6. **Submit**
   - **Wait time: 2-14 days**

📏 Step 6: Understand Rate Limits

Instagram Graph API Rate Limits

Per Instagram Account: - 200 API calls per hour - Scales linearly: 10 accounts = 2000 calls/hour

Per Endpoint: - Posting: 25 posts per day per account - Comments: 60 replies per hour - Insights: 200 requests per hour

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🚨 Common Mistakes

❌ Mistake 1: Personal Account Used

Problem: Instagram Graph API works ONLY with Business accounts **Solution:** Convert to Business account (see Step 1)

❌ Mistake 2: Not Linked to Facebook Page

Problem: API calls fail with "No linked Facebook Page" **Solution:** Link Instagram Business account to Facebook Page

❌ Mistake 3: Skipped Business Verification

Problem: Permissions rejection - "Business verification required" **Solution:** Complete Meta Business Verification first (see Facebook guide)

⏱️ Complete Timeline

Phase	Duration
Instagram Business Account	10 min
Facebook Page Linking	5 min
Meta Business Verification	3-7 days
Instagram Product Setup	10 min
Permission Request (App Review)	2-14 days
Total	**3-8 weeks**

📊 Content Posting Specifications

Photo Posts

- **Formats:** JPG, PNG
- **Size:** Max 8MB
- **Aspect Ratio:** 4:5, 1:1, 1.91:1
- **Caption:** Max 2200 characters
- **Hashtags:** Max 30

Video Posts

- **Formats:** MP4, MOV
- **Size:** Max 100MB
- **Length:** 3 sec - 60 min
- **Caption:** Max 2200 characters

Stories

- **Photo:** JPG, PNG (max 8MB)
- **Video:** MP4, MOV (max 100MB, 15 sec max)
- **Aspect Ratio:** 9:16
- **Duration:** 24 hours

Reels

- **Format:** MP4, MOV
- **Size:** Max 1GB
- **Length:** 15-90 seconds
- **Aspect Ratio:** 9:16

✅ Complete Checklist

Prerequisites:

- [ ] Meta developer account
- [ ] Meta Business Verification complete
- [ ] Instagram Business Account created
- [ ] Instagram linked to Facebook Page
- [ ] Facebook Page Admin rights

App Setup:

- [ ] App created in Meta developer portal
- [ ] Instagram product added
- [ ] OAuth redirect URIs configured
- [ ] Test Instagram accounts added

Permissions:

- [ ] Required permissions identified
- [ ] For each permission: video walkthrough created
- [ ] Use case descriptions written
- [ ] Test credentials prepared
- [ ] Privacy policy complete

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